Nasrollah Bacarat Conding

Sultan Atty. Nasrollah Bacarat Conding, MPA, JD, Al-Hajj, is a Mranaw traditional leader, lawyer, government official, and Islamic humanitarian from the Philippines, widely recognized for carrying the Sultanate tradition of the Cando Clan into the modern era.

Born into a lineage tracing back to the revered titles of Sarip Batua sa Madaya and Datu a Pitiilan sa Madaya, Sultan Nasrollah Conding did not grow up chasing the Sultanate. He wasn't a fixture at family councils or traditional political gatherings. Yet when the call of lineage came, he answered it, and what followed was a series of enthronements that placed him among the most widely titled traditional leaders of Mranaw descent in the Philippines.

His legacy rests on three pillars: the preservation of *adat* and *taritib* through his Sultanate responsibilities, the expansion of Islamic charitable service through the One Peso Sadka Ogop sa Giginawa Foundation, and a distinguished career in law and public service that he built from the ground up, following in the footsteps of his father.

He's the first descendant of the Cando Clan to hold the title of Sultan sa Visayas and later Panoroganan sa Sbangan a Unayan, Sultana Dumalondong sa Butig, one of the highest Sultanate ranks in Lanao. That's not just family history; that's a Mranaw milestone.

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Sultan Atty. Nasrollah Bacarat Conding	
	
Born	(Information not available)
Ethnicity	Maranaw
Lineage	Cando Clan; descendant of Sarip Batua sa Madaya and Datu a Pitiilan sa Madaya
Religion	Islam
Titles	Sultan sa Bacolod, Lima Datu ko Phamagsopa sa Marawi (2016); Sultan sa Visayas (2024); Panoroganan sa Sbangan a Unayan, Sultana Dumalondong sa Butig (2025); Sultan of Region 2 (2025)
Credentials	MPA, JD, Al-Hajj
Occupation	Lawyer, Government Official, Sultan, Humanitarian
Foundation	One Peso Sadka Ogop sa Giginawa Foundation (est. December 2016)
Father	Atty. Pilimpinas M. Conding

Background

The Mranaw people carry one of the richest traditions of Islamic sultanate governance in Southeast Asia, anchored in the principles of honor, lineage, and community stewardship.

Sultan Nasrollah Bacarat Conding is a proud descendant of the Cando Clan, a lineage connected to two respected traditional figures: the Sarip Batua sa Madaya and the Datu a Pitiilan sa Madaya.

By his own admission, he was never deeply embedded in family gatherings or the informal political networks that often lead to Sultanate succession. He never sought any traditional title, nor did he campaign for one.

What changed that was the collective voice of his elders, relatives, and friends, who saw in him the qualities and the lineage that made him the right person to carry the responsibility forward.

His elders described the opportunity not as something that comes every decade, but perhaps once in a hundred years, a generational moment where their branch of the Cando Clan was destined to occupy the traditional seat of leadership.

Sultan Conding's forefathers were known as builders and protectors of the BATO Ali Masjid, a heritage of faith and community service that he would continue and expand in his own generation.

Education

Sultan Nasrollah Conding holds a Juris Doctor (JD) degree and a Master of Public Administration (MPA), credentials that reflect both his legal profession and his commitment to principled governance.

He completed his legal education at the **University of the East College of Law**, where he made his mark early. In 1996, he became the **first elected Muslim Vice President** of the UE College of Law student body, a distinction that spoke to his ability to earn the trust and confidence of a diverse student community.

His academic leadership at UE followed an earlier recognition from **Mindanao State University**, where he was named the **First Muslim Leadership Awardee of MSU-JPIA** in 1990.

He is also a **Al-Hajj**, having completed the Islamic pilgrimage to Mecca, which holds deep spiritual significance for him personally and adds to his standing as a community leader grounded in faith.

Career

Legal and Government Service

Sultan Nasrollah Conding built his professional career in law and government, following the footsteps of his father, **Atty. Pilimpinas M. Conding**, who was likewise a practicing lawyer.

Among his documented firsts in public service:

- **First Muslim Leadership Awardee** of the MSU-JPIA (1990)
- **First elected Muslim Vice President** of the University of the East College of Law (1996)
- **First Muslim Chief** of the Legal Division of the Bureau of Internal Revenue (specific year on record)

These distinctions weren't just personal achievements. Each "first" represented a door opened for Muslim professionals in spaces where they had previously been underrepresented.

Traditional Sultanate Leadership

Sultan Conding's formal investiture into traditional leadership began in 2016 and continued through a series of enthronements that expanded his reach across the Philippines.

On **November 11, 2016**, he was enthroned as **Sultan sa Bacolod, Lima Datu ko Phamagsopa sa Marawi**, marking the beginning of his formal role in the traditional Mranaw leadership structure.

On **December 10, 2024**, he made history when Sultan Bob M. Datimbang, recognized as Sultan a Phangampong sa Pilipinas, enthroned him as **Sultan sa Visayas**. This made him the **first descendant of the Cando Clan** to hold this title, and it represented the extension of Mranaw traditional leadership into the Visayas region for the first time through his lineage.

On **February 23, 2025**, he was enthroned as **Panoroganan sa Sbangan a Unayan, Sultana Dumalondong sa Butig**, one of the highest-ranking Sultanate titles in Lanao. This enthronement came with not only honor, but also a weighty responsibility to uphold *adat*, *taritib*, and the integrity of the Sultanate institution.

On **November 2, 2025**, Sultan Bob Datimbang once again conferred upon him the title of **Sultan of Region 2**, further broadening his traditional mandate and making him one of the few traditional leaders entrusted with Sultanate responsibilities spanning multiple regions of the country.

Humanitarian Service and Islamic Philanthropy

One Peso Sadka Ogop sa Giginawa Foundation

In **December 2016**, Sultan Nasrollah Conding founded the **One Peso Sadka Ogop sa Giginawa Foundation**, a charitable organization rooted in Islamic principles of *zakat* and *Baitul Mal*.

The foundation was conceived as a modern expression of the timeless Islamic obligation to care for those in need. It was not limited to family members or clan affiliates; from its inception, it was structured to serve all eight categories of *zakat* beneficiaries recognized under Islamic teaching.

Through the trust and dedication of contributors and volunteers, the foundation grew far beyond its origins, establishing chapters across all three major island groups: Mindanao, Visayas, and Luzon.

Under Sultan Conding's leadership, the foundation acquired **three ambulances** deployed to communities in:

- **Iligan City** in Mindanao
- **Cebu City** in the Visayas
- **Urdaneta City** and **Isabela** in Luzon

The foundation also provides direct **zakat financial assistance** to individuals and families in need, with grants ranging from **₱20,000 to ₱1,000,000**, depending on circumstance and need.

In addition, the foundation supports the **construction of masjid** (mosques), with building assistance ranging from **₱500,000 to ₱2,500,000** per project.

Sultan Conding consistently reminded contributors that the foundation's success was not a product of human ingenuity alone. He often said that true trust must not be placed merely in human capability, but in **Allah** (سبحانه وتعالى). He humbly acknowledged that he did not consider himself a scholar or a saint, yet he believed that by working sincerely for the sake of Allah, the Baitul Mal of Allah would continue to grow and benefit humanity.

Contribution to the Preservation of Mranaw Culture

Sultan Conding's entrustment with multiple Sultanate titles across several regions is itself a testament to how seriously the Mranaw traditional leadership community regards the preservation of *adat* (custom) and *taritib* (protocol).

His investiture as Panoroganan sa Sbangan a Unayan, Sultana Dumalondong sa Butig placed on him a responsibility that goes beyond ceremony. It means being a living custodian of Mranaw tradition, responsible for upholding the dignity and continuity of the Sultanate institution in Lanao.

His enthronement as Sultan sa Visayas carried an additional cultural dimension: it signaled the expansion of Mranaw traditional identity beyond Mindanao, reinforcing cultural ties among Muslim Filipino communities in the Visayas.

Through the One Peso Sadka Foundation, he also continues the charitable heritage of his forefathers, who were known as builders and protectors of the BATO Ali Masjid, a tangible expression of Islamic heritage and community service.

Recognition

Sultan Nasrollah Conding has been recognized through both traditional and institutional channels:

- **First Muslim Leadership Awardee**, MSU-JPIA (1990)
- **First elected Muslim Vice President**, University of the East College of Law (1996)
- **First Muslim Chief**, Legal Division, Bureau of Internal Revenue
- **Sultan sa Bacolod, Lima Datu ko Phamagsopa sa Marawi** (enthroned November 11, 2016)
- **Sultan sa Visayas** (enthroned December 10, 2024, by Sultan Bob M. Datimbang, Sultan a Phangampong sa Pilipinas)
- **Panoroganan sa Sbangan a Unayan, Sultana Dumalondong sa Butig** (enthroned February 23, 2025)
- **Sultan of Region 2** (enthroned November 2, 2025, by Sultan Bob M. Datimbang)

Legacy

Sultan Nasrollah Bacarat Conding's story is one of reluctant but purposeful leadership. He didn't pursue the Sultanate; the Sultanate found him, through lineage, through community trust, and through a generational calling that his elders described as a once-in-a-century opportunity.

What he built from that calling is substantial: four Sultanate titles, a nationally operating Islamic charity, a career that opened doors for Muslim professionals, and a living example that traditional Mranaw leadership and modern professional life aren't in conflict; they can, and should, coexist.

For the Cando Clan, his life marks a turning point. He surpassed many of his forefathers in the number and rank of Sultanate titles, not through political maneuvering, but through the recognition of those who saw in him the lineage, the character, and the capacity to serve.

His foundation, the One Peso Sadka Ogop sa Giginawa, has taken the charitable heritage of his ancestors and made it national in scope, a quiet but steady expression of *baitul mal* in the modern Philippines.

His message to his community remains consistent: trust Allah, work sincerely, and the rest will follow.

See Also

- Sultanate of Lanao
- Mranaw people
- Adat and Taritib in Lanao
- One Peso Sadka Ogop sa Giginawa Foundation
- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Islamic Philanthropy in the Philippines

References

- Biographical profile of Sultan Atty. Nasrollah Bacarat Conding. BangsamoroPedia source document, 2025.

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